
Got stuck? What to do next

There comes a time in every transdisciplinary project when doubt strikes, hands are tied and the dot on the horizon is lost. This is known as the 'Blue Monday'. If you have reached that point, you can implement following questions and exercises to regain perspective. *

Find the dot on the horizon

Questions:

When has the transdisciplinary education project succeeded?

What stands in the way?

What are the blind spots?

What milestones did we achieve so far and which do you still want to achieve?

Assignment:

Imagine we are 2 years on. Our project was a great success. What did we achieve? And what was the follow-up?

Plans

Questions:

What still really needs to be done?

What are we not yet doing in the transdisciplinary project and what should we definitely need to do?

What are you going to do right now, to move the project forward?

How can we get more out of our planning?

Assignment:

Look at the intention (or possibly at the goals) and adjust them where necessary.

Look at the planning made earlier and adjust it where necessary.

Collaboration

Q uestions:

How can we optimise our collaboration in the project?

What are your strengths in working together? How do these help us move forward now?

How can we take care of each other now that we are struggling?

What resources can we best use now?

Assignment:

Share experiences with each other in which cooperation was optimal and name the success factors.

Success experiences

Questions:

Tell about a moment which you enjoyed. What made that moment so nice?

Describe a moment when the TDO project was at its best.

Name 3 small things that are going well in the TDO project.

What does our TDO project need now to be successful?

Assignment:

Dreaming: Suppose we are some time on and super successful as a TDO project. A lot has been achieved in a short time. Everyone cooperates, enjoys the work and the target group has been reached. Describe what has been completed, how we did it and by whom. Write it down individually and exchange all the answers. Immediately work ideas that arise into follow-up actions

Not-knowing

Questions:

Tell about a time when you didn't know how to proceed. How did you get out then?

When you don't know, a lot lies open. What lies open now and what opportunities might this present?

Not knowing can make you uncertain. What helps you in times of uncertainty?

Not knowing often evokes resistance. How do you deal with resistance constructively?

Assignment:

Dealing with uncertainty and not-knowing is a much needed competence in the contemporary work field. 'Not knowing' does a lot to people and often evokes resistance. What can you do to better cope with not-knowing? Exchange ideas on this and try them out.

Letting go

Questions:

What from the TDO project would you like to get rid of?

What do you think we as a group should let go of?

What do you find difficult to let go of in the TDO project?

What have you achieved in the TDO project and can you now let go of?

Assignment:

Bring an object to the meeting that symbolises what you are going to let go of from the TDO project. Exchange with each other and decide to actually let go.

Ownership

Questions:

What do you feel responsible for in the TDO project?

How do we notice that you take responsibility?

What energises you in the TDO project?

What makes someone trustworthy to you?

Assignment:

Reflect together on the meaning of ‘be your own leader’. See how you can best take responsibility and how you can support others in their responsibility. Make agreements to take action.

*** Based on the quartet game by Ankie Schoemakers of AWG and by Meike Koop of AWEG, research group Mind the Gap by Henk Spies from Avans UAS.**